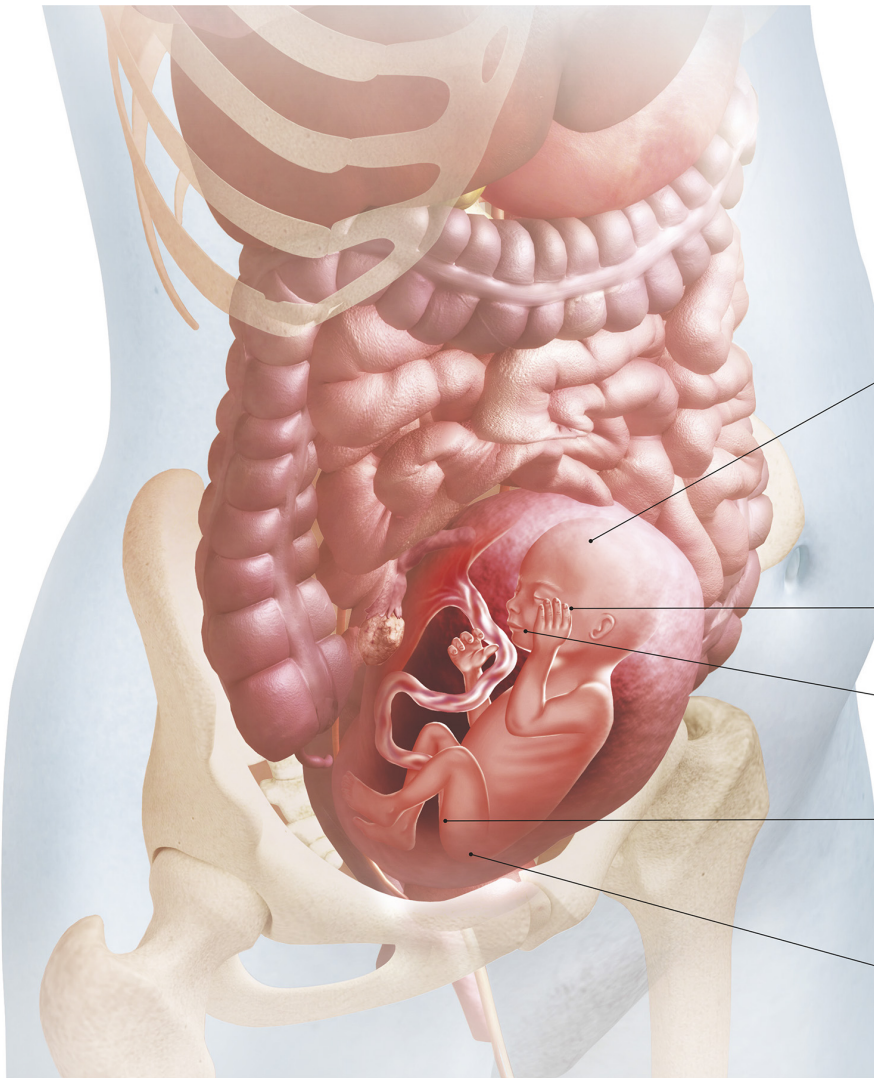




The developing brain is picking up electrical signals from the baby's body about sensations such as pressure and temperature. At this stage, a baby's nervous reactions are not conscious but simply reflexes.

Fingernails are beginning to grow. There's no danger of the baby scratching himself, since his skin is covered in vernix, a protective waxy coating.

The baby is regularly swallowing the amniotic fluid in increasing amounts.

In girl babies the ovaries have descended from the abdomen into the pelvis.

At 21 weeks the average crown to heel length is 10.5 in (26.7 cm) and the average weight is 12.7 oz (360 g).